

For more effects

Read Microsoft's page on plug-ins for Windows Media player at tinyurl.com/digit-effects

Internet radio station

To learn how you could set up your own internet radio station, go to tinyurl.com/digit-wa-tutorial

Watch your music!

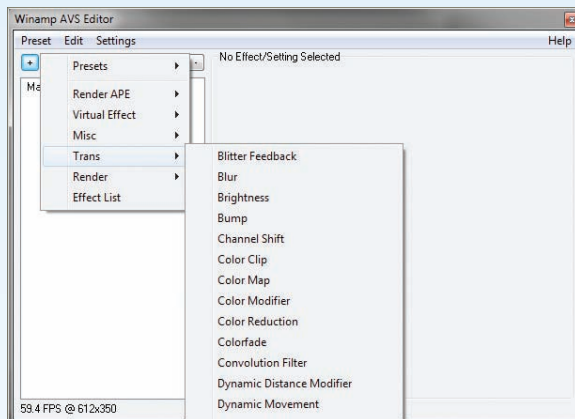
Add colour to your favourite psychedelic music while watching amazing visualisations that add to the whole effect!

Rahil Banthia

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Visualisations in any media player, are just dynamic add-ons or plugins that produce images, colours and textures that change based on elements in the music being played. If you're not happy with the default visualisations, worry not! We'll show you how to create your own.

Although we'll create our own visualisation in Winamp, you can do create similar visualisations in Windows Media Player, KM Player or any other player that supports plugins. Winamp offers two primary



Adding a Module in AVS

visualisation plugins: AVS(Advanced Visualization Studio) and MilkDrop.

These allow you to create different presets, the term used for outputs of a visualisation platform. Using these, you can customise the visualisers and get any effect you want.

Let's start with AVS visualisation environment and see how we can combine the library of inbuilt effects in endless ways and create our own AVS visualisation preset masterpiece.

What's AVS?

For starters, AVS is the mother of all Winamp visualisation plug-ins that lets you build a countless number of custom visualisations from an ever-expanding library of effects. It supports windowed/fullscreen rendering, preset customisation, module stacking, skinnable windows, support for Sonique visual plug-ins, and a ton of other features. The best part is that it comes bundled with all versions of Winamp after v2.6, so everyone can get a taste of its visual sonic goodness.

How to create presets?

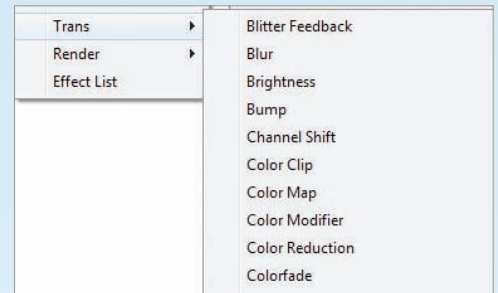
Let's start by making a simple preset with one render module and a few trans

modules that will subtly manipulate the effects. To get started, run Winamp and change the present to AVS from Preferences. Then right-click on the AVS window and open the AVS Editor. Click on preset. This will give you a drop down menu, where you've to choose the New blank preset option.

Click on Main in the new window that pops up and make

sure the option to "Clear every frame" in the right pane is unchecked, so that the screen is not painted black at the start of each frame. This will make the visualization appealing and continuous. Now, let's add an effects module to this new preset. For this, you've to click on + and then select **Render > Moving Par-**

ticle. The right pane will change now and show you various options that you can associate with this module. Choose a colour that you want in the colour box that pops up when you click on the label "color" in that. Enable the Onbeat Sizechange option. By now, you've created a blob of colour that

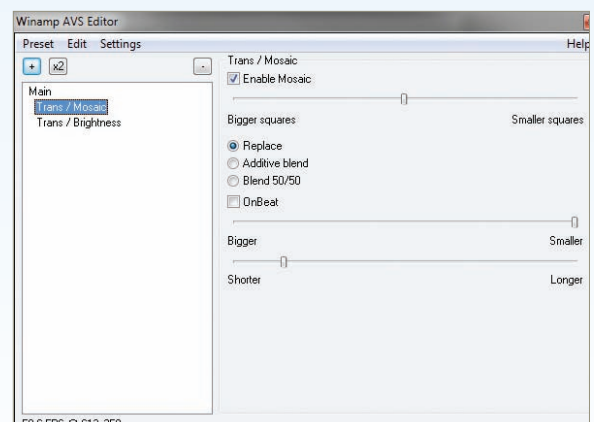


Add the Water, Blur and Movement trans modules

moves based on the music that you will play along with this visualisation.

Let's add some transitions to it, because come on, how interesting is a moving blob of colour? Click on + and add three Trans modules: **Water, Blur and Movement.** In the Movement module, select sunburster from the right pane. This is our basic visualisation, more or less. You can experiment with any permutations of the existing modules and with minor modifications, they turn into completely new effects. An interesting one to check out is the Effect module "up or down" which ensures that your visualization plays with sequencing.

If you want to delve deeper into AVS and create visualisations with more effects, you'll not be left disap-



The right pane of a Mosaic module with the settings available to you